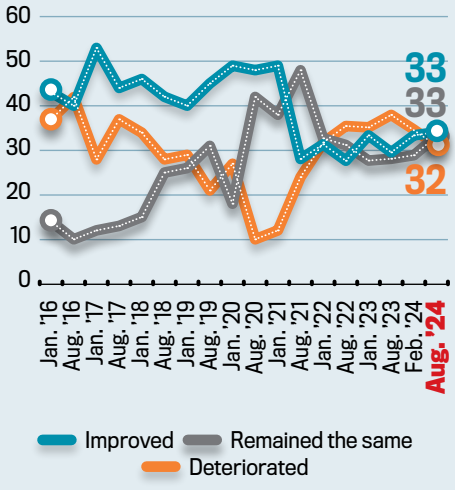
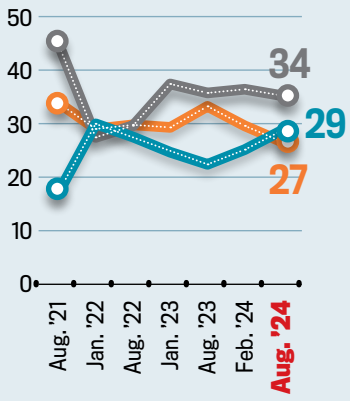
Q. How has your economic status changed since Narendra Modi took charge as PM?



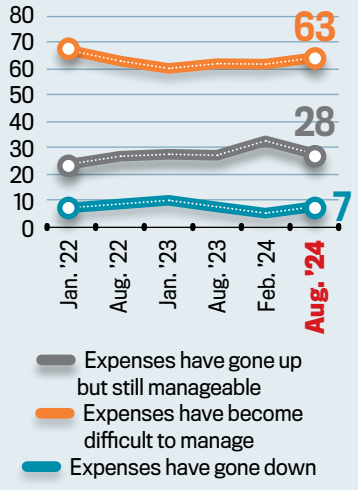
Few are convinced their economic status has improved since Modi became PM

Q. Is your household income/ salary likely to improve?



Most respondents believe their household income will stay the same

Q. How do you compare your current daily expenses to that of last year?



Many individuals have a hard time covering their daily expenses

Rest, DK/ CS

poses a challenge given the vagaries of the weather, which affects their income.

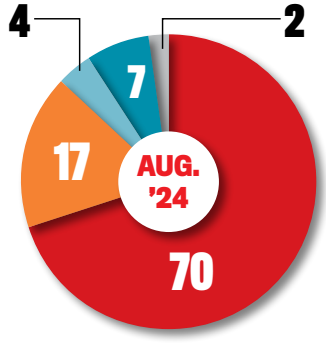
Moreover, 57.3 per cent of the total workforce is self-employed, and 18.3 per cent work as unpaid labour in household enterprises. Casual labour comprises 21.8 per cent of the total workforce, while regular wage and salaried workers make up just 21 per cent. In fact, according to the current MOTN, many are sceptical of the government's claim of having created 80 million jobs in the past three years, with as many as 57 per cent of the respondents disagreeing with this assertion. The International Monetary Fund's first deputy managing director, Gita Gopinath, has stated that India needs 60-148 million more jobs in the next six years until 2030, which would require broad-based growth across different sectors.

Against this backdrop, it is not surprising that 78.3 per cent of the respondents consider the unemployment situation in India to be serious, up from 71 per cent in February. Given the gravity of the issue, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced the 'Prime Minister's Package' in Budget 2024, which

87%

of the respondents say that it's difficult to get a government job in India

Q. How difficult is it to get a government job in India?



All figures in % and rounded off

includes five major employment-related schemes with an ambitious Rs 2 lakh crore outlay spread over five years to facilitate jobs and skills development for the country's 41 million youth. The idea hinges on subsidising both employment and employability. But will these proposals create more jobs? Opinion is divided, with just over half of those polled believing it will. Meanwhile, the allure of government jobs continues. Despite 70.3 per cent of the MOTN respondents finding it extremely difficult to secure a government job, such positions are still preferred. When asked if they would choose a government job with a 25-30 per cent lower salary over one in the private sector, more than 70 per cent said they would still take the government job.

Regarding changes to the income tax in the budget, 49 per cent of those polled seem satisfied with the proposals, while around 39 per cent are dissatisfied. The budget increased the standard deduction for salaried employees opting for the new tax regime from Rs 50,000 to Rs 75,000. Similarly, the deduction on family pensions for pensioners has been enhanced from Rs 15,000 to